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Lamentations

Lamentations 1:1 (#1)

What has the city become like even though she was once great among the nations?

The city has become like a widow, alone and without protection.

Lamentations 1:3 (#1)

What can Judah not find even though she lives among the nations?

Judah can find no rest even though she lives among the nations.

Lamentations 1:5 (#1)

Why has Yahweh afflicted Jerusalem?

Yahweh has afflicted Jerusalem because of her many transgressions.

Lamentations 1:6 (#1)

What has left the daughter of Zion?

All of her majesty and beauty have left the daughter of Zion.

Lamentations 1:7 (#1)

What did Jerusalem remember in the days of her affliction?

Jerusalem remembered all of her precious things that she had in former times.

Lamentations 1:8 (#1)

Because Jerusalem sinned greatly, what is the result?

Jerusalem is now regarded as something abhorrent and defiled.

Lamentations 1:10 (#1)

Who has Jerusalem seen enter her sanctuary even though Yahweh commanded that they must not enter?

Jerusalem has seen the nations enter her sanctuary.

Lamentations 1:11 (#1)

What do the people do as they search for bread?

The people groan as they search for bread.

Lamentations 1:13 (#1)

What has Yahweh spread for the feet of Jerusalem?

Yahweh has spread a net for the feet of Jerusalem.

Lamentations 1:14 (#1)

What is the result of the God placing the yoke of Jerusalem's transgressions on her neck?

The result is that Jerusalem's strength has stumbled and they are given into the hands of their enemies.

Lamentations 1:15 (#1)

What has the Lord done to the virgin daughter of Judah?

The Lord has crushed the people of Judah like someone treading on grapes in a winepress.

Lamentations 1:16 (#1)

Why have Jerusalem's children become desolate?

Jerusalem's children have become desolate because the enemy has prevailed.

Lamentations 1:18 (#1)

Who has gone into captivity because Jerusalem rebelled against Yahweh's commands?

Jerusalem's young women and young men have gone into captivity.

Lamentations 1:19 (#1)

Who died in the city while they sought food to restore their lives?

Jerusalem's priests and elders died in the city.

Lamentations 1:20 (#1)

What is the result of Jerusalem's rebellion?

Jerusalem is in anguish and their hearts are completely devastated.

Lamentations 1:21 (#1)

What do the enemies of Jerusalem do when they hear of her calamity?

The enemies of Jerusalem rejoice.

Lamentations 1:22 (#1)

What does Jerusalem request that Yahweh do to her enemies?

Jerusalem asks that Yahweh would deal with her enemies just as Yahweh has dealt with her for all her transgressions.

Lamentations 2:1–2 (#1)

How does the Lord express his anger because of Jeremiah's rebellion?

He has taken away the splendor of Israel and has humbled and brought down the cities of Judah.

Lamentations 2:3–4 (#1)

How does his anger affect Israel and Zion?

The Lord removed all of Israel's power, refused to protect them from their enemies, and he allowed them to be destroyed.

Lamentations 2:5–6 (#1)

How is the Lord's anger shown?

The Lord has become like an enemy; he destroyed the palaces and the temple and has rejected both the king and priest.

Lamentations 2:7 (#1)

Why does the enemy shout triumphantly?

They shout triumphantly because the Lord abandoned his own holy place and has given the walls of the palace over to them.

Lamentations 2:9 (#1)

What has happened to the gates and bars of Zion?

Her gates have come down, and Yahweh has destroyed and smashed the bars that held them shut.

Lamentations 2:10 (#1)

How do the elders and virgins show they are grieving?

The elders sit on the ground, sprinkle their heads with dust while dressed in sackcloth. The virgins bow their heads down to the ground.

Lamentations 2:11–12 (#1)

Why is the writer weeping?

He weeps over the death and destruction of his people and because there is nothing for them to eat or drink.

Lamentations 2:15–16 (#1)

What do the mockers do as they pass by the city?

They rejoice over the destruction by clapping their hands, hissing and shaking their heads with contempt, and grinding their teeth with hatred.

Lamentations 2:18–19 (#1)

What does the writer encourage the people of Jerusalem to do?

He says they should cry out to the Lord and lift their hands to him continuously for the sake of their children.

Lamentations 2:20 (#1)

Why are the people begging for Yahweh's mercy?

They are begging for God's mercy because they are extremely hungry and because their priests and prophets are being slaughtered.

Lamentations 2:21–22 (#1)

How does the writer describe the day of Yahweh's wrath?

On the day of Yahweh's wrath, the enemy killed young and old, no one survived, and they showed no mercy.

Lamentations 3:3 (#1)

What does the writer say that Yahweh has turned against him all the day?

Yahweh has turned his hand against the writer all day long.

Lamentations 3:7 (#1)

What does the writer say that Yahweh has built around him so that he cannot escape?

Yahweh has built a wall around him and trapped him.

Lamentations 3:10 (#1)

To what animal does the writer compare Yahweh and say that it is waiting to ambush him?

The writer describes Yahweh as a bear that is waiting to ambush him.

Lamentations 3:14 (#1)

What has the writer become to all his people?

The writer has become a laughingstock to all his people.

Lamentations 3:17 (#1)

What can the writer no longer remember since Yahweh has removed peace from his life?

The writer can no longer remember any happiness.

Lamentations 3:19–20 (#1)

What is the writer's mood as he calls to mind his affliction?

The writer's mood is one of deep depression within himself as he calls to mind his affliction.

Lamentations 3:23 (#1)

What does the writer say occurs anew every morning?

The writer says that Yahweh's merciful actions occur again every morning.

Lamentations 3:25–26 (#1)

What is Yahweh like toward the one who waits for him and to those who wait in silence for the salvation of Yahweh?

Yahweh is good to those who wait for him and wait quietly for Yahweh's salvation.

Lamentations 3:32 (#1)

What does Yahweh show, even though he brings grief?

Yahweh shows compassion even though he brings grief.

Lamentations 3:33 (#1)

From where does Yahweh not oppress or torment the sons of men?

Yahweh does not oppress from his heart or enjoy causing grief for the sons of men.

Lamentations 3:38 (#1)

Who is the one who decides what happens—both the bad things and the good things?

The Most High God is the one who decides what will happen.

Lamentations 3:40–41 (#1)

What should the people do as they search their hearts and examine their ways and turn back to Yahweh?

The people should lift up their hearts and their hands in prayer to God in the heavens.

Lamentations 3:42 (#1)

What should the people admit that they have done against Yahweh as they pray?

They should admit that they have sinned and rebelled against Yahweh.

Lamentations 3:45 (#1)

What does the writer say that Yahweh has made them to be among the peoples?

Yahweh has made them to be garbage and refuse among the peoples.

Lamentations 3:48–49 (#1)

How does the writer describe the tears that flow from his eyes?

His tears are streams of water that flow out from his eyes.

Lamentations 3:52–54 (#1)

What does the writer say as his enemies hunt him and silence his life in a pit and cast a stone against him?

He says that he has been cut off and will die.

Lamentations 3:55–57 (#1)

What did Yahweh tell the writer when he called on Yahweh's name and asked Yahweh to hear his cry for help?

Yahweh told him not to fear.

Lamentations 3:59 (#1)

What does the writer ask Yahweh to do after seeing his wrong?

He asks Yahweh to judge his case.

Lamentations 3:63 (#1)

What does the writer say he is to his enemies, whether they sit or rise?

He is the object of their mocking song.

Lamentations 3:64 (#1)

What does the writer ask Yahweh to do to his enemies?

He asks Yahweh to pay back to them as much harm as they have done.

Lamentations 3:66 (#1)

What does the writer ask Yahweh to do to his enemies?

He asks Yahweh to pursue his enemies in his anger and destroy them everywhere under the heavens.

Lamentations 4:1 (#1)

To what does the writer compare the people of Jerusalem?

The writer compares the people of Jerusalem to gold that has become tarnished and to holy stones that have been scattered at the corner of every street.

Lamentations 4:2 (#1)

What were the sons of Zion, and how are they now valued?

The sons of Zion were precious, weighed against fine gold, but now they are regarded as clay jars, the work of a potter's hands.

Lamentations 4:3 (#1)

What does the writer compare the daughter of his people to?

He compares her to the ostriches in the wilderness, who are fierce and do not care for their young.

Lamentations 4:4 (#1)

What happens to the tongue of the nursing baby, and what are the children asking for?

The tongue of the nursing baby sticks to the roof of his mouth with thirst, and the children ask for food, but there is nothing for them.

Lamentations 4:5 (#1)

What has happened to the ones who used to eat the finest food and used to wear scarlet clothing?

The ones who used to eat the finest food are now starving in the streets, and the ones who used to wear scarlet clothing now search through piles of garbage looking for something to eat.

Lamentations 4:6 (#1)

How great is the guilt of the daughter of his people?

The guilt of the daughter of his people is greater than the sin of Sodom.

Lamentations 4:7–8 (#1)

What were her Nazarites like before, and how are they now?

Her Nazarites were purer than snow, healthy, attractive, and vigorous. Now darkness has darkened their form, they are unrecognizable in the streets, and their skin has shriveled on their bones and become as dry as wood.

Lamentations 4:9 (#1)

What does the writer say about those killed by hunger compared to those killed by the sword?

The writer says that those killed by the sword were better off than those who slowly wasted away from hunger.

Lamentations 4:10 (#1)

What did the compassionate women do with their children?

They boiled their own children and the children became their food.

Lamentations 4:11 (#1)

How did Yahweh bring his wrath to completion?

Yahweh brought his wrath to completion by pouring out his fierce anger and kindling a fire in Zion that consumed her foundations.

Lamentations 4:12 (#1)

What did the kings and the inhabitants of the world not believe could happen to Jerusalem?

They did not believe that an adversary and an enemy could enter the gates of Jerusalem.

Lamentations 4:13 (#1)

What did the prophets and priests do in the city?

The prophets sinned greatly and the priests did evil things, and they poured out the blood of the innocent people right in the city.

Lamentations 4:14 (#1)

What happened to those prophets and priests?

They stumbled about blind in the streets, defiled with blood, so that no one was able to touch their clothes.

Lamentations 4:15 (#1)

What did people shout at the defiled prophets and priests?

People shouted at them to go away, calling them unclean and telling others not to touch them.

Lamentations 4:15 (#2)

Where did the prophets and the priests go?

They fled and wandered among the nations, but the nations said they could not stay.

Lamentations 4:16 (#1)

What did Yahweh do to the scattered prophets and priests?

Yahweh scattered them and will no longer watch over them.

Lamentations 4:16 (#2)

How are the priests received and how are the elders received?

The priests are not respected anymore and the elders are not shown any concern.

Lamentations 4:17 (#1)

What happened when the people watched and waited for help from the nations?

They watched in vain, and the nation they hoped would rescue them was not able to save them.

Lamentations 4:18 (#1)

What did the enemy do to the people?

The enemy tracked their every step so that they could not walk freely through their own streets.

Lamentations 4:18 (#2)

What did the people say about their end?

They said their end was near and the time for their destruction had come.

Lamentations 4:19 (#1)

How does the writer describe the pursuers, and what did they do?

The writer describes the pursuers as swifter than the eagles of heaven; the pursuers set upon them on the mountains and lay in wait for them in the wilderness.

Lamentations 4:20 (#1)

What happened to Yahweh's anointed, our king?

Yahweh's anointed was captured in the enemy's pits.

Lamentations 4:21 (#1)

Why is the daughter of Edom told to rejoice and be glad?

She is told to rejoice and be glad, but the cup of judgment will also pass to her, and Yahweh will punish and humiliate her, too.

Lamentations 4:22 (#1)

What is the daughter of Zion told?

She is told her guilt is ended and Yahweh will no longer keep her in exile.

Lamentations 4:22 (#2)

What is the daughter of Edom told?

The daughter of Edom is told Yahweh will punish her guilt and will uncover her sins.

Lamentations 5:1 (#1)

What does the writer ask Yahweh to do?

The writer asks Yahweh to remember what has happened to them and to see their disgrace.

Lamentations 5:2 (#1)

What does the writer tell Yahweh has happened to their inheritance?

The writer tells Yahweh that their inheritance has been turned over to strangers and their houses to foreigners.

Lamentations 5:5–6 (#1)

How does the writer describe what is happening to them?

He says that their enemies run after them, that they are weary, and they have reached out to the Egyptians and Assyrians for food.

Lamentations 5:7 (#1)

What are the people saying about their suffering?

They are saying that their fathers sinned and then died, and they are suffering for what their fathers did wrong.

Lamentations 5:8 (#1)

What are the people saying about the slaves?

The people are saying that slaves rule over them and there is no one to rescue them.

Lamentations 5:9 (#1)

How do they describe themselves when they go out to get bread?

They risk their lives to get bread outside the city because violent people in the wilderness will try to kill them.

Lamentations 5:10 (#1)

How do they describe their skin?

Their skin grows hot as an oven from the fever of hunger.

Lamentations 5:11 (#1)

What happened to the women and virgins in Zion and Judah?

Women are raped in Zion and virgins in the cities of Judah.

Lamentations 5:12 (#1)

What happened to the princes and the elders?

Princes are hung by their hands and the elders are shown no honor.

Lamentations 5:13 (#1)

What happened to the young men and boys?

The young men grind with millstones, and the boys stagger under heavy loads of wood.

Lamentations 5:14 (#1)

What happened to the elders and the young men?

The elders ceased from the gate and the young men from their songs.

Lamentations 5:15–16 (#1)

How do they describe the joy of their heart, their dances, and their honor?

Their joy has ceased, their dances have changed into mourning, and they have lost the honor they once had.

Lamentations 5:17 (#1)

What do they say about their hearts and eyes?

Their hearts have become sick, and their eyes have grown dim because of their tears.

Lamentations 5:18 (#1)

What does the writer say has happened to Mount Zion?

Mount Zion is desolate and foxes roam over it.

Lamentations 5:19 (#1)

What do they say about Yahweh's reign and throne?

Yahweh reigns forever and his throne is from generation to generation.

Lamentations 5:20–21 (#1)

What do they ask Yahweh?

They ask Yahweh whether he is forgetting them for so long, and if he will turn them back to himself.

Lamentations 5:22 (#1)

What does the writer fear Yahweh may have done?

He fears Yahweh may have utterly rejected them and may be angry with them beyond measure.